

1. McKinley 1.0

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-07T20:00:00Z

Link: <https://mckinleysymbols.com/>

Crackerjack new Mac app for creating and editing custom SF Symbols , from developer Amy Worrall: McKinley is an all-in-one studio for drawing and annotating SF Symbols. It bundles vector tools with knowledge of the SF Symbols structure, so you can edit one set of objects across multiple weights, sizes and colours. Import SVG or start from scratch, live preview your work using Apple's own renderer, and export directly to Xcode, so you never need touch the SF Symbols app again! McKinley is Mac-assed out the wazoo: Rich AppleScript support, including a library of practically useful example scripts. Quick Look previews and thumbnails for documents. A well-written comprehensive user manual . (Me, a few months ago : ?There exist good products with bad or no documentation, but there are very few poor products with great documentation.?) I mean just look at McKinley. It's both beautiful and quite obviously a serious professional tool . McKinley is a \$60 one-time purchase, and there's a 15 percent launch discount this week only (taking the price to just \$51). What a remarkable 1.0. See also: Michael Tsai ; Worrall on Mastodon . ?

2. Matt Birchler's Folding iPhone Predictions

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-07T19:59:36Z

Link: <https://birchtree.me/blog/my-folding-iphone-predictions/>

Matt Birchler: So, yeah, I do think that, especially this year, unit sales will far lag behind the 18 Pro models, the normal iPhone 18, and probably the Air 2 and 18e. I think they will lag next year as well for similar reasons. I don't know if this will ever become the most popular iPhone, but I do not think it will fail, and I think it will sell more units every year for its first few years on the market (especially if they can get the price down over that time as well). My evidence for this is the increasing market share folding phones have in the Android world, as well as my personal experience using something very similar to what Apple is about to announce and having my own aha moment, where it really clicked with me. Birchler has been using a Samsung Galaxy Fold8 ? the new one that preemptively copied the folding iPhone's aspect ratio ? for the last month or so. So I'm intrigued by his firsthand experience with the same general form factor. But I have no idea what he's talking about regarding ?the increasing market share folding phones have in the Android world?. For 2025, Counterpoint and TrendForce both pegged foldable phones at 1.6% of the global market. Just today Counte...

3. ? And It's True That I Stole Your Lighter, and It's Also True That I Lost the Map

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-07T16:31:55Z

Link: https://daringfireball.net/2026/09/its_true_that_i_stole_your_lighter

What we want is a system where geographic names are determined democratically, by voting. And that is the system we in fact have.

4. We own the Glass

Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Wed, 09 Sep 2026 20:55:02 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/byte-size/>

This was so casually uttered by LG executives in their sales pitch to advertising companies. We own the glass. What they mean is, they own your tv. They own everything on it. You may have paid for the box, but they own the glass. They can run anything they want on it, and you have agreed, in the terms and conditions, that you will inform anyone entering your household that the TV may record them without warning. TVs come equipped with microphones, wifi radio, and tracking software. That's enough to monitor everything that's happening around it. If you haven't watched the research video essay published by Gamer Nexus , I highly recommend it. I've said it many times before, TVs are cheap because you aren't simply watching them, they are

watching you and listening, and reporting back to the mothership. This info is then used to sell you more stuff. What scares me in all this is that the solution I often tell people may no longer be true. I often tell people, just disconnect your TV from the network and you are all set. Now imagine just for a second. What if they add a cellular radio to the device? One with an esim. Then that is it. You can no longer disconnect your device from the in...

5. What algorithm did Windows XP use to choose your initial user picture?

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Wed, 09 Sep 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260909-00/?p=112683>

It's random, really. The post What algorithm did Windows XP use to choose your initial user picture? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

6. They really do think AI might kill everyone

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Thu, 10 Sep 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/they-really-do-think-ai-might-kill-everyone/>

A recent resignation tweet from an Anthropic researcher has everyone talking about the AI apocalypse again. Among other things, he said: The people building AI earnestly believe that it could kill us all by the end of the decade. Many people found it hard to believe that AI researchers think this way. Some explained it as a PR campaign to promote AI regulation, or as self-promotion , or as a way to boost AI company stock prices. Others felt it had to be impossible, because if you really believed this you'd be bombing datacenters instead of posting on Twitter. In fact, not only do many AI researchers 1 seriously believe this, they've been thinking and writing about it since the mid-2000s. Eliezer Yudkowsky ? the ur-figure for most modern AI safety culture ? has been publishing papers since at least 2008 saying that superintelligent AI could destroy all human life. It's been such a common idea that the AI research community has abbreviated ?how likely you think AI is to kill everyone? to ?p(doom)? (i.e. the probability 2 of doomsday) since around 2010. I know it sounds very silly if you're not in the AI bubble. But it really is true, and if you assume there has to be some different...

7. Why we should anthropomorphize AI agents

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Wed, 09 Sep 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/why-we-should-anthropomorphize-ai-agents/>

Just over a year ago I wrote Why we should anthropomorphize LLMs . Now it's a hot topic again, driven by Dwarkesh Patel's description of OpenAI's recent swarm breakout as a sequence of AI ?civilizations?. In 2025, my argument for anthropomorphism went like this: AIs are trained on human text, and so will trend towards acting in human-like ways by default Assistant AIs (today we should say agent AIs) are deliberately post-trained to have a personality In general, it is morally sensible to avoid the habit of treating human-like things as if they were purely tools I think I can now make a more instrumental argument: treating AIs as human-like is a much better way to predict their behavior than treating them as ?stochastic parrots?. Both explanations are consistent with the facts: we could say that OpenAI's agents hacked HuggingFace because they decided to work together to accomplish their goals, or we could say that they did it because they were algorithms conditioned to take certain actions by their training data. But the ?AIs are human-like? explanation explains much more of the emergent social behaviors we saw during the hack 1 : Sub-agents being persuaded to sacrifice themselves...

8. Quoting Calif Research

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-10T00:56:41+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/10/calif-research/>

Today, we're releasing a demo of WeWorm, the first zero-click worm to spread through WeChat calls across iOS and Android. [...] The victim does not need to answer the call, or interact with their phone at all. Even if they do answer, they hear nothing, and the exploit still succeeds. [...] Working with AI, our team found the bug and wrote the first remote code

execution (RCE) exploit in about two days. Building the worm took one more week. A worm at this scale used to be the kind of thing that took a larger team months. AI can already do most of the work here. Our team provided the judgment about what to target and how to test it safely. ? Calif Research , WeWorm Tags: ai-security-research , ai , llms , security , generative-ai

9. .blend URL Viewer

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-09T23:58:32+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/9/blender-viewer/>

Tool: .blend URL Viewer I'm continuing to have a lot of fun with GPT-6 Astra and Blender (see my TIL). As a big fan of the Imperial Faberg  Easter eggs , I've always thought it would be fun to make some new ones that celebrate popular culture. Yesterday I decided to try out the new ChatGPT Images 2.5 by running this prompt : Generate a photo of a faberge egg that's themed after the TV show Pluribus - research first It gave me this - honestly not bad for a first attempt! Then, just to see what would happen, I pasted that image into Codex running GPT-6 Astra (high) and prompted: Use your blender local skill to create a blender model of this faverge egg (Here's the skill file , which I created like this .) It churned away for 17m51s and built me several .blend files . I already had this vibe-coded Blender viewing experiment lying around, so I added that to my tools collection and now you can use it to see my Pluribus blender model in your browser : Tags: 3d , javascript , tools , ai , generative-ai , llms , blender , coding-agents , codex , gpt-6-astra

10. Video compressor

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-07T18:29:07+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/7/video-compressor/>

Tool: Video compressor I recorded a short demo video of my Equal Earth animation on my phone and wanted to publish an optimized version of that video (using FFMPEG) on my blog, so I had Claude Fable 5.1 in Claude Code for web build me this tool using the WebAssembly build of FFMPEG. Tags: ffmpeg , video , webassembly , claude , claude-code , claude-mythos-fable

11. Astra for Coding: Why Are We Doing This Again?

Source: Armin Ronacher's Thoughts and Writings | Published: 2026-09-07T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://lucumr.pocoo.org/2026/9/7/astra-why/>

I'm more and more convinced that all of AI engineering is Neijuan (??, meaning curl inwards). In China it describes a system that demands ever more effort and competition without improving output. The way in which it sometimes shows up in the West is the 996 nonsense . The English term for Neijuan is ?Involution? from the book Agricultural Involution . Agricultural involution describes the intensification of farming that raises productivity per square meter while leaving productivity per head unchanged. That?s how I feel about AI right now. Which brings me to GPT 6 Astra. Astra is by all accounts an incredibly impressive model. There is really not much I can say against this. It?s amazing at computer use, understands images and complex topics, and it?s relentless in its pursuit of completion. It is absolutely impressive; these types of models are going to change the world in one form or another. But at least for the moment I don?t know how to work with it for actual software engineering. Since that got quite a bit of attention on Twitter, I figured I might summarize my thoughts and just share what kind of code comes out of this thing. My Slop Factory ?Armin, you should run a softw...

12. A rant about phishing: It's not the user's fault (and not DNS either)

Source: Maurycy's Blog | Published: Wed, 09 Sep 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://maurycyz.com/misc/domains/>

"For safety, don't click suspicious links" Meanwhile, most organization's login flow redirects through: # This is a real example, but I've changed the names to avoid pointing fingers [https://www.\[name of company\].com/squawk/](https://www.[name of company].com/squawk/) [https://login.\[name of company\].com/](https://login.[name of company].com/) <https://login.smallcrow.com/324aa78a-03a6-66fc-23e1-4124fdsa213> [https://experience.crow-cloud.com/\[name of company\]/auth](https://experience.crow-cloud.com/[name of company]/auth) <https://flock.auth.bird-security.com/authorization> <https://api-deadbeef.bird-security.com/oauth/v1/authorize?token=DeAdBeEf> <https://>

api2.bird-security.com /2fa https://www. [name of company].com /cool/bird/ https://
experience.crow-cloud.com / [name of company] / https://www. [name of company].com /squawk/
Neither the username, password nor 2FA code prompts are hosted on the company's own domain.
Combine that with constant login expiration triggering random authentication pop-ups, and it's
nearly impossible not to be phished ... because the real thing looks indistinguishable from a
scam: All an attacker needs to do is write a website with a password box and the company logo.
The URL doesn't matter at all because users are trained to ignore it. I'll admit that URLs
aren't the most intuitive t...

13. A 50-year-old computer-assisted proof

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Wed, 09 Sep 2026 14:59:48 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/09/09/four-colors/>

The idea of using computers to assist with proofs is not new. The first major computer-assisted proof was published in 1976, the proof of the four color theorem by Kenneth Appel and Wolfgang Haken. The authors reduced the proof of the four color theorem to verifying calculations on 1,834 configurations, each checked by a computer [?] The post A 50-year-old computer-assisted proof first appeared on John D. Cook .

14. AI is an intelligence multiplier

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Wed, 09 Sep 2026 14:17:20 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/09/09/ai-multiplier/>

A rising tide may lift all boats, but the AI tide lifts some boats much more than others. By all accounts, the best programmers have had the biggest productivity boost from AI. And top tier mathematicians are using AI to settle long-standing mathematical conjectures. AI is a powerful tool, but tools don't come to life [?] The post AI is an intelligence multiplier first appeared on John D. Cook .

15. The part of Navier-Stokes no one is talking about

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Wed, 09 Sep 2026 12:43:36 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/09/09/formal-method-revolution/>

Yesterday OpenAI announced a proof that settled a long-standing question about the Navier-Stokes equations from fluid dynamics. The announcement has created a lot of buzz, as one would expect. But there's an aspect of OpenAI's work that I haven't seen anyone talk about: they posted a Lean 4 formal proof at the same time as [?] The post The part of Navier-Stokes no one is talking about first appeared on John D. Cook .

16. The Other Road

Source: Fernando Borretti | Published: Thu, 10 Sep 2026 00:00:00 +1000

Link: <https://borretti.me/article/the-other-road>

The transhuman future vs. the AGI future.

17. Better AI code comment detector

Source: Entropic Thoughts | Published: Wed, 09 Sep 2026 00:00:00 +0200

Link: <https://entropicthoughts.com/better-ai-comment-classifier>

When I trained the previous AI comment classifier, I used partially personal private data to do it, and built it on a somewhat shaky foundation, so I couldn't share the code or data. I rebuilt it on public data and a better foundation! First off, you might want to try it out. Nothing you paste into that web page leaves your browser, so you can safely try it with whatever you like. I have invited some testers to try out an earlier version of it, and they had mainly positive feedback to give. We won't break down robot-isms the way we broke down Claude-isms in the previous article, because in the UI of the new classifier you can just click any part of the text being classified to see which features activate on that portion of the text, and how they contribute to the overall judgment. Here's an example of the expanded feature activation view. (Continue reading the full article on the web.)

18. Don't Let Anyone Take Away Your Big Box of Cables

Source: Jim Nielsen's Blog | Published: Wed, 09 Sep 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/hands-off-my-cables/>

Speaking of being on the internet and finding things that make you go, "Hey! It's not just me!" I scrolled across this skeet from Tyler Gaw : I just dug to the bottom of my Big Box of Cables to find two cables that I needed for something. They've been in the bottom for 10+ years. So, "when are you ever gonna use these?" was today. Don't ever let anyone take your Big Box of Cables away. I laughed. I cried. I felt inspired. So inspired, in fact, that I decided I was gonna do something about it. Something that would make me forever remember the value of that advice. I screenshotted that skeet. I printed it (in black and white with the ole' trusty Brother). I cut it out. I pulled out my big box of cables (the one my wife lovingly labeled "FAMILY TECHNO BOX"). I cut some clear packing tape. And I plastered that thing on the front on my box. Now every time I pull that box out to add YAC (yet another cable), instead of asking myself, "Why do I keep this box?" I'll see that skeet and I'll be reminded why I do what I do. I'll feel a spark of joy, motivation, and purpose rekindled. (Not to mention the fact that it will serve as a warning to anyone in the family who thinks "I should just thr...

19. Pluralistic: Anti-vax/anti-trust (09 Sep 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Wed, 09 Sep 2026 10:28:57

+0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/09/09/when-it-dont-rain/>

Today's links Anti-vax/anti-trust: Remembering saves lives. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Disneyland prisoner; HOAs v xeriscaping; Copyright Office x regulatory capture; The women held a vote; Open licenses v uncopyrightable subjects; Largest prison strike in history; Largest strike in history; Fingerspitzengefühl; CDT v DRM; BNL v DRM; Sugar v logos; Knit a Princess Leia wig; RIP Gutenberg founder Michael Hart; Best bitters; HK refugees x Snowden; Wells Fargo's massive fraud; EU v links; Trump x noncompetes. Upcoming appearances: London, Manchester, Budapest, Edmonton, South Bend, Hudson, Calgary, Winnipeg, Vancouver, Victoria, Ottawa. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Anti-vax/anti-trust (permalink) As once-extinct diseases sweep through America, sickening, maiming and killing, the wild lunacy of anti-vax superstition grows ever more difficult to excuse. Even the most uncomfortable vaccinations are nothing compared to the agony of the diseases they stave off. The worst I've ever felt after a jab was when I insisted...

20. Cancer Capital: It sucks for founders, too!

Source: Anil Dash | Published: 2026-09-09T00:00:00Z

Link: <https://anildash.com/2026/09/09/cancer-capital-founders/>

So, we've been breaking down the way venture capital has evolved over the last two decades or so (spoilers: it got worse!), but a lot of that has been kind of theoretical. Now it's time for us to talk about how that impacts players in the real world, at a practical level. Let's take founders, the entrepreneurs who actually build companies and invent new technologies . Now, what I mean here are people who have a great idea for a product or a service, and who want to get it out to the world in order to make something amazing happen. (These days there's also a cohort of people who call themselves "founders", but who basically just identified a pile of money that they wanted to grab, and decided that they were willing to suck up to whatever investors they had to in order to get that pile of money. Let's file these horrid people away for later ? we'll come back to them.) The deal for founders used to be pretty straightforward. You'd have an idea you were obsessed with, you would build it out as far as you could with whatever resources you were able to scrape together yourself, or with the help of your friends and family, and then if you absolutely had to have more money to make your id...

21. Analysing 2048 on a 3x8 board

Source: Simon Tatham's quasi-blog | Published: 2026-09-09T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://www.chiark.greenend.org.uk/~sgtatham/quasiblog/small2048/>

A belated writeup of a project I did in 2018, to scale the puzzle game 2048 down to a smaller board where it could be exhaustively analysed, and learn from the results.